means of transport and communication, the development of new trade routes during 19th century had strengthened the trade centres and urban areas. The latest development in urbanisation was noticed in the continent of Africa. Before 1930, Africa had towns only on its coasts but now it has 50 towns with population exceeding 10,00,000. Major cities in Africa are Cairo, Nairobi, Mombasa, Bulawayo, Duala, Abidian, Logos, Accra, Addis Abba, Leopoldville, Luanda, Cape Town, Natal, Pretoria etc. Thus, in modern age, the accelerating urbanisation is resulting in a redistribution of population throughout the world.



Modern Urbanisation



In 1950, 30% of the world's population was urban, and by 2050, 68 % of the world's population is projected to be urban (World Urbanisation Prospects, 2018, Key facts).

World Urbanisation

S.No	Name of the Region	Urban Population in %
1	North America	82
2	Latin America and Caribbean	81
3	Europe	74
4	Oceania	68
5	Asia	50
6	Africa	43
World Average		**55**

Source: World Urbanisation Prospects, 2018, Revision, Key facts.

World Top Five Cities

S.No	Name of the City	Population in million
1	Tokyo *(Japan)*	37
2	Delhi *(India)*	29
3	Shanghai *(China)*	26
4	Mexico city *(Mexico)*	22
5	Sao Paulo *(Brazil)*	22

Source: World Urbanisation Prospects, 2018, Revision, Key facts

Consequences of Urbanisation

a) Housing and Slums: There is a lack of space for housing and a marked reduction in the quality of housing in the urban areas due to increase in population. This problem may increase in the years to come. Rapid rate of urbanisation results the development of slums.



Slums

b) Over Crowding: Over-crowding leads to unhealthy environment in the urban areas. It also the cause of many diseases and riots.

c) Water supply, Drainage and Sanitation: No city has round the clock water supply in the world. Drainage situation is equally bad. The removal of garbage is a Himalayan task for urban local bodies.

d) Transportation and Traffic: Lack of planned and adequate arrangements for traffic and transport is another problem in urban centres. The increasing number of two wheelers and cars make the traffic problem worse. They cause air pollution as well.

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